INDIA TODAY SS STATE OF THE STATES

MADHYA PRADESH FIRST

# DRAWING A GROWTH BLUEPRINT



**The Madhya Pradesh First Conclave showcased a diverse range of ideas, aiming to explore how the state can unlock its full potential and achieve inclusive, sustained growth**

By Rahul Noronha

IT **WAS A CONFLUENCE OF POLICY, PERFORMANCE AND PERSPECTIVE** to chart Madhya Pradesh's path to its next phase of growth. Held on April 25 in Bhopal, INDIA TODAY's State of the States Madhya Pradesh First Conclave brought together politicians from across the spectrum, civil servants, academicians, industrialists, professionals, actors, hoteliers, a humorist, wildlife experts and subject experts. Over a series of sessions, speaker after speaker addressed the central theme—how to realise the state's full potential and drive its next leap forward.

Marking his 500th day in office, Chief Minister Mohan Yadav outlined his government's priorities and the policy changes being introduced across key sectors to achieve the desired goals. First up, he highlighted efforts to shore up investments, including a shift toward local engagement through regional industry summits. Dwelling on the need to simplify processes for businesses, he said, "Earlier, if anyone wanted to set up an industrial unit, they would have to get clearances from multiple sources. But now we have made collectors responsible for all permissions by creating an industries cell so that all permissions can be secured at one point." Later in the day, Raghwendra Singh, Principal Secretary, Industrial Policy and Investment, reinforced this point. "Ease of doing business is not a slogan in Madhya Pradesh, but a reality," he said.

In a session focused on the dairy sector, Gujarat assembly Speaker Shankar Chaudhary—who also heads Banas Dairy—shared his experience of turning around the sector in Gujarat and how similar efforts could be replicated in neighbouring MP. He was joined by Dr Sanjay Govani, MD, MP State Cooperative Milk Federation, who outlined the steps he plans to take to make dairy more remunerative.

Even though promoting manufacturing was a key part of the agenda, the criticality of agriculture to MP can never be lost. In a session on elevating agriculture to the enterprise level, M. Selvendran, Secretary, Department of Farmer Welfare, listed the initiatives launched towards this end, while Siraj Hussain, former Union Agriculture Secretary, mentioned, among other things, the challenges ahead for the sector.